Brute Force Incident Report

Finding	Result
Target User	`john.smith`
Failed Login Attempts	`500`
Attacker IP	`10.10.242.248`
Attack Duration	`4.75 minutes`
Successful Login	`Yes`
Target Host	`System-utm`
First Failed Login	`09/17/2025 09:01:50.282799`
Last Failed Login	`09/17/2025 09:06:35.029531`

Analysis

The investigation identified 500 failed authentication attempts against the `john.smith` account from the source IP `10.10.242.248`.

The activity started at `09:01:50` and continued until `09:06:35`, resulting in an attack duration of approximately 4.75 minutes.

A successful login was observed after the brute-force activity. This indicates that the attacker may have successfully obtained access to the targeted system and requires further investigation.

Analyst Verdict

TRUE POSITIVE — BRUTE FORCE ATTACK

The authentication activity is consistent with a brute-force attack against the `john.smith` account. The high number of failed attempts, identified source IP, short attack period, and subsequent successful login indicate that the activity should be treated as a security incident.

Recommended Response

1. Investigate the successful login immediately.
2. Identify the account used for the successful login.
3. Review commands and processes executed after authentication.
4. Investigate whether privilege escalation occurred.
5. Reset the compromised account credentials.

6 Block or investigate the source IP `10.10.242.248`.

7 Continue monitoring `System-utm` for additional suspicious activity.